bunted the fourth delivery past the bowler for four and then took a single off the fifth. With Gul bowling the next over, I scrambled two past point and then flicked a single to mid-wicket, and so took my score to 278.

Graeme instantly made the declaration with our total at 584 for nine, but I will always be grateful for his generosity, his willingness to give me my moment in the sun. The feat of setting a new highest score by a South African in Test cricket was an important moment for me and my family, a moment that had seemed unthinkable during all the years when I was simply trying to smack as many boundaries as possible.

Records are made to be broken, of course, and I was also genuinely pleased for Hashim Amla when he duly raised the bar even further by scoring an unbeaten 311 against England at The Oval in 2012.

Both the Test in Abu Dhabi and the series against Pakistan in the UAE were eventually drawn, and our squad returned home to complete the year with an appetising three-Test home series against India.

It was perhaps one of the strangest anomalies in international cricket. Jacques Kallis, one of the greatest batsmen of any era, had not scored a double century in a Test match; at least, he hadn't until the first Test match against India at SuperSport Park just before Christmas 2010, and I was thrilled to be batting with him when he set the record straight.

We had dismissed the Indians for 136, with Morné Morkel taking five for 20, and were aiming to bat ourselves into an unassailable position. Graeme and Alviro Petersen delivered an opening stand of 111, and both Hashim and Jacques moved serenely towards their centuries.

Once I joined Jacques at the crease early on the third morning, we set about the task of taking charge of the Test, utterly dominating the attack and enjoying every moment of another wonderful day. I was fortunate to reach my century just before lunch from only 75 balls, the fastest century ever scored by a South African in a Test match but, more importantly, Jacques continued to advance towards his maiden